by suffering. Liberation (*kaivalya* – 'wholeness', 'isolation') from the *samsaric* cycle of unsatisfactory becoming results from the discriminating insight, presupposing the discipline of ***Yoga***, that the conscious principle is distinct from the physical and psychological sphere. *Prakriti* ceases to function in relation to the enlightened spirit. Liberation occurs when the ***gunas*** are reabsorbed into *prakriti*. The soul recovers its true form, detached from mental modifications.

Some *Samkhya* thinkers accepted the existence of God, who is pure awareness, without asserting that he either creates or is involved in the domain of souls and matter.

Further reading: Hiriyanna 1993; Larson 1979; Larson and Bhattacharya 1987

Samkhya (number): numbers are classified by the ***Vaisheshikas*** as one of the sub-varieties of the category (***padartha***) quality (***guna***). A quality is a non-repeatable particular property. The particular grey belonging to the sky outside is different from, although belonging to the same type as, the grey of my hair. Qualities can only be properties of substances (***dravya***). In the case of number we can say that every object has a unit-quality distinct from but of the same kind as every other unit-quality. The quality 'two' inheres in each member of a pair and 'three' in each of a triad, and so on. But because numbers are qualities, the ***Vaisheshika*** system does not let us ascribe a number to a multiplicity of qualities (although we can count the objects in which the quality inheres). In response to this problem, the ***Nyaya*** philosopher *Bhasarvajna* denies that numbers are qualities and understands them in terms of identity and difference. To say that something is one (or that there is one of something) is just to assert the entity's identity. Saying two and so on is asserting difference.